

Clear of Piccolo, away from the cook and his ladle, we break the seal.

INFILTRATE THE CASTLE

Messengers – you asked to be trusted. Here is how you earn it.

Before this night is over, we move against the Order, but we move half-blind. The Komtur of the castle, Albrecht, knows more about us than we would like. We need to know what he knows – and how much.

He is a proud man. He walks outside the castle walls as if the city were already his, certain no one would dare touch him. *(Do not go into the ruins themselves – they are watched, and barred to the likes of you. Find him in the open, before the walls.)*

YOUR TASK: get close to him. Talk to him. But do it as someone he wants to talk to.

WEAR ANOTHER FACE – the carnival lends you one for free. Half the city is masked tonight; one more set of strangers eager to talk means nothing. You are not couriers, and you are NEVER, EVER OF THE COUNCIL – say that and you are dead. You are townsfolk who smell which way the wind blows: little people, eager to please the Order, who have *heard things* about those plotting against it. He feeds on that. Offer him a whiff of a name, a rumour, a hint that you know who schemes – and let him talk. Draw him out. See what he lets slip.

Flatter him. Let him boast. A proud man with something to hide always shows more than he means to.

When he is done with you, he will put something in your hand. Take it, thank him, and walk away. DO NOT OPEN IT IN FRONT OF HIM. Once you are clear of the walls and his eyes, open it. It will tell you what to do next.

Burn nothing. Trust no one in a Teutonic mantle. – J.

Scouts, then. We can be scouts. Find the proud Komtur, smile, lie a little, and listen. A man that sure of himself never hides things well.